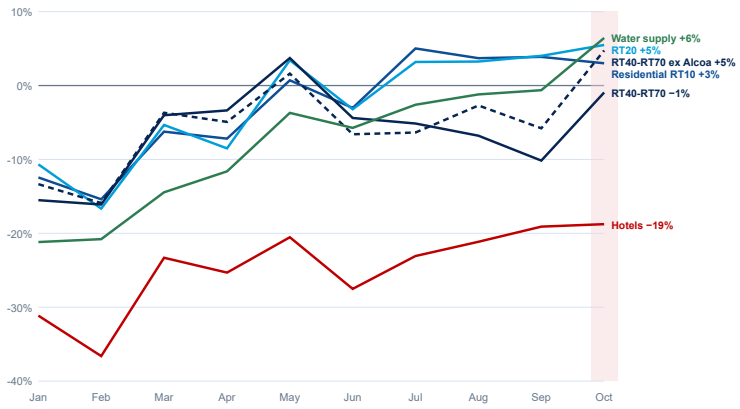
October 2026: how far has the recovery got?

Residential and small commercial are through the recovery. Large commercial is not: hotels are still 19% down, Alcoa has left the grid and the hurricane-hit west is still below last year.

Recovery is still under way in three places. **Hotels** have narrowed the gap to last year from 31% in January to 19%. **The western parishes** are closer but not back. And **7,742 more residential premises than before the storm** are still billing zero consumption, a number that has not moved since June. Everywhere else we are either back above where we were before the storm (residential, RT20, water supply) or lower for a structural reason (Alcoa and the industrial customers).

YEAR ON YEAR BY MONTH, 2026 VS 2025



October looks stronger than it is because the October 2025 base includes the storm of 28 October (shaded). Prepaid is included.

WHAT THE TREND TELLS US

- Residential has run above last year since July (+5.0%, +3.7%, +3.9%, +3.0%) and is +6.2% on October 2024, the last clean October.
- Large commercial (RT40 to RT70) slipped from −5.1% in July to −10.2% in September. Without Alcoa it ran −6.4% to −5.8%, so the commercial base was still short of last year before October.
- October's +4.7% for large commercial excluding Alcoa reflects the weak storm base. It is not a turn. Hotels, still 18.8% down, show what that base is hiding.
- Water supply is the one large commercial group fully back (+6.4%).

RECOVERY SCORECARD

Indicator	Now vs comparison	Change	Status
Residential RT10 vs Oct 2024 (pre-storm, postpaid)	106.2 vs 100.0 GWh	+6.2%	Recovered
RT20 vs Oct 2024 (postpaid)	60.8 vs 55.0 GWh	+10.4%	Recovered
RT40 to RT70 vs Oct 2024	124.5 vs 129.0 GWh	−3.5%	Not recovered
RT40 to RT70 ex Alcoa, Jan to Oct vs 2025	1,139 vs 1,202 GWh	−5.3%	Not recovered
Hotels, October vs 2025 (January was −31%)	17.3 vs 21.3 GWh	−18.8%	Recovering
Water supply, October vs 2025 (January was −21%)	19.9 vs 18.7 GWh	+6.4%	Recovered
RT10 customers at zero kWh vs pre-storm (Oct 2025)	58,886 vs 51,144	+15.1%	Not recovered
Residential in the west vs 2025 (Westmoreland −8%, Hanover −4%, St James −3%, St Elizabeth −2%)	west parishes	−3.5%	Not recovered

THE WEST

St James, Westmoreland, Hanover, Trelawny and St Elizabeth together ran −5.7% on last October, against a base the storm had already depressed there, so the shortfall is real. The Montego Bay hotels are the largest piece: St James commercial is 15.7% below last year and 18.0% below budget.

WHAT WE NEED TO SEE

Hotels within 10% of last year once the December reopenings (1,982 rooms) land. Residential premises at zero consumption back under 53,000. Western residential back above last year. We are not there on any of the three yet.

Comparisons with 2024 exclude prepaid, held only from 2025.

Parish recovery tracker: October 2026

Residential volumes are above last year in the east and centre and still below it in the west. The commercial gap sits in St James (hotels) and Clarendon (Alcoa).

RESIDENTIAL (RT10): YEAR ON YEAR BY MONTH, 2026 VS 2025

Parish	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct*	Oct GWh	YTD	Gap closed Jan to Sep (pts)	Oct vs Oct 2024
KSAS	+9	−5	+5	−1	+5	−2	+7	+5	+6	+5	9.2	+3.6%	−3	+11.4%
KSAN	+2	−6	+3	−4	+4	0	+7	+9	+9	+6	21.7	+3.5%	+7	+6.2%
St. Catherine	−1	−7	−3	−3	+3	0	+8	+7	+6	+6	13.7	+1.9%	+6	+9.2%
St. James (W)	−30	−24	−14	−10	−4	−8	−1	−1	0	−3	9.8	−8.9%	+30	+1.0%
St. Ann	−15	−14	−6	−5	−1	−5	+3	0	0	+3	7.2	−3.6%	+14	+6.3%
Portmore	+1	−7	−2	−4	+7	−3	+7	+5	+7	+3	10.3	+1.7%	+6	+7.6%
Clarendon	−2	−7	0	−3	+4	−1	+5	+4	+5	+5	6.5	+1.3%	+6	+9.5%
Westmoreland (W)	−73	−60	−41	−31	−22	−11	−1	−6	−7	−8	4.3	−25.6%	+66	−5.2%
Manchester	−11	−9	−1	−3	+4	−2	+4	+2	+2	+3	5.7	−1.0%	+12	+6.5%
St. Elizabeth (W)	−56	−46	−30	−24	−11	−8	−1	0	−1	−2	5.2	−17.3%	+54	+6.9%
Trelawny (W)	−37	−27	−12	−11	−4	−8	+1	−3	0	0	2.9	−9.3%	+37	+3.1%
St. Mary	−1	−10	−1	−1	+1	−1	+7	+2	+2	+4	4.5	+0.4%	+3	+6.2%
Portland	+1	−9	0	−1	+8	0	+10	+6	+6	+6	3.2	+3.0%	+5	+9.3%
St. Thomas	+4	−5	+2	0	+8	−1	+10	+6	+8	+7	2.7	+4.1%	+4	+10.6%
Hanover (W)	−36	−29	−13	−13	−5	−9	0	−2	−5	−4	2.3	−11.5%	+32	−2.6%
Total	**−12**	**−15**	**−6**	**−7**	**+1**	**−3**	**+5**	**+4**	**+4**	**+3**	**108.9**	**−2.1%**	**+16**	**+6.2%**

COMMERCIAL (RT20 TO RT70): YEAR ON YEAR BY MONTH, 2026 VS 2025

Parish	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct*	Oct GWh	YTD	Gap closed Jan to Sep (pts)	Oct vs Oct 2024
KSAS	−2	−3	+7	+9	+21	−2	−6	−1	−5	+15	46.8	+2.7%	−3	+6.4%
KSAN	−3	−11	+1	−6	+5	−3	+4	+4	+5	+7	30.9	+0.3%	+8	+10.3%
St. Catherine	−4	−14	+4	−7	−5	+1	+1	−1	+3	+10	22.1	−1.2%	+8	+15.4%
St. James (W)	−29	−36	−24	−25	−22	−23	−18	−14	−16	−16	20.1	−22.1%	+14	−12.7%
St. Ann	−21	−19	−6	−8	−1	−7	−6	−5	−2	0	11.9	−7.3%	+19	−4.6%
Portmore	−6	−7	−1	−1	+4	0	−24	+22	−26	+5	7.0	−3.6%	−21	+5.8%
Clarendon	−27	−14	−3	+12	+23	+17	+117	−56	−37	−38	9.3	−9.3%	−9	−40.4%
Westmoreland (W)	−39	−40	−24	−17	−7	−9	0	−4	+1	−1	9.5	−13.9%	+39	−1.7%
Manchester	−8	−8	0	−2	+6	+4	+7	+8	+5	+5	5.9	+1.9%	+13	+13.1%
St. Elizabeth (W)	−46	−39	−25	−23	−12	−12	−8	−3	−7	+3	6.4	−17.0%	+39	+13.5%
Trelawny (W)	−20	−24	−13	−10	+6	−7	−2	0	+5	+8	5.0	−5.6%	+25	+12.0%
St. Mary	−16	−15	−8	−7	−7	−6	+3	+1	+4	+4	3.1	−4.7%	+19	−10.5%
Portland	−1	−10	0	−2	+9	−3	+2	0	−1	−1	2.2	−0.7%	0	+3.8%
St. Thomas	+4	0	+3	+6	+18	+9	+12	+12	+11	+8	2.6	+8.4%	+8	+14.6%
Hanover (W)	−22	−27	−12	−8	+17	−4	+2	−2	−5	+2	2.5	−6.0%	+17	+4.1%
Total	**−14**	**−16**	**−4**	**−5**	**+4**	**−4**	**0**	**−7**	**−6**	**+1**	**185.4**	**−5.1%**	**+8**	**+0.7%**

(W) marks the five hurricane-hit western parishes. *October 2025 includes the storm of 28 October, so October is flattered; the last column compares postpaid volume with October 2024, a clean year. Gap closed is September's year-on-year less January's, in percentage points. Colours: green at or above last year, amber to 10% below, light red 10 to 20% below, red over 20% below.

WHAT IT SHOWS

- **Residential, west:** −3.5% on October 2025, against +5.0% in the east and centre. Last October's base was already depressed in the west, so the gap is real.
- **Residential, all parishes:** January −12%, September +4%, October +3% (flattered). Year to date −2.1%.
- **The west has plateaued, not finished:** Westmoreland reached −1% in July and has slipped to −8%; Hanover is −4% and St Elizabeth −2%. St James commercial has sat between −23% and −14% since May, so hotels are not closing the gap on their own.
- **Commercial:** January −14%, September −6%, October +1%. Year to date −5.1%. Portmore's swings (−24, +22, −26, +5) are Caribbean Broilers' billing timing, not demand.

Where: parish, industry and KAM

Growth is concentrated in Kingston and St Catherine. St James and Clarendon pull the other way, and each has a single explanation.

BY PARISH

Parish	Residential (RT10)			Commercial (RT20 to RT70)				Total vs 2025 (GWh)
	Oct 26	vs 2025	vs Sep	Oct 26	vs 2025	vs budget	vs Sep	
KSAS	9.2	+5.5%	−2.4%	46.8	+14.9%	+12.0%	+3.0%	+6.54
KSAN	21.7	+6.3%	−5.4%	30.9	+6.6%	+4.9%	+0.3%	+3.21
St. Catherine	13.7	+5.8%	−5.7%	22.1	+10.5%	+3.1%	+4.3%	+2.84
St. James	9.8	−2.6%	−7.8%	20.1	−15.7%	−18.0%	+1.0%	−4.02
St. Ann	7.2	+3.4%	−6.5%	11.9	0.0%	−4.7%	+0.7%	+0.23
Portmore	10.3	+3.3%	−6.2%	7.0	+4.5%	+0.4%	+34.6%	+0.63
Clarendon	6.5	+5.1%	−2.4%	9.3	−38.3%	−40.8%	−2.8%	−5.44
Westmoreland	4.3	−8.5%	−5.2%	9.5	−1.1%	−6.3%	−0.5%	−0.50
Manchester	5.7	+2.6%	−0.5%	5.9	+5.2%	+4.7%	+2.0%	+0.44
St. Elizabeth	5.2	−1.9%	−2.9%	6.4	+3.2%	+6.3%	+5.4%	+0.10
Trelawny	2.9	−0.3%	−7.9%	5.0	+8.1%	+1.8%	+3.5%	+0.37
St. Mary	4.5	+3.8%	−4.1%	3.1	+4.0%	−10.3%	−0.3%	+0.28
Portland	3.2	+6.2%	−2.9%	2.2	−1.3%	+2.9%	+4.8%	+0.16
St. Thomas	2.7	+6.9%	−5.5%	2.6	+8.5%	+6.4%	+3.0%	+0.38
Hanover	2.3	−4.5%	−2.5%	2.5	+1.9%	−3.5%	+9.0%	−0.06
Total	**108.9**	**+3.0%**	**−4.9%**	**185.4**	**+1.1%**	**−2.3%**	**+2.8%**	**+5.16**

Prepaid is shown in its parish. Residential is not compared with budget by parish because the parish budgets are an allocation of the national figure. Commercial is compared with the account budgets.

BY INDUSTRY (ACCOUNTS RT20 AND ABOVE), LARGEST CHANGES ON 2025

Industry	Oct 26	vs 2025	vs Sep	vs budget*
Mining (Alcoa)	3.0	−6.88	−0.02	−7.47
Cement Manufacturing	9.1	+4.78	−0.01	+0.78
Hotels and Motels	17.3	−4.00	+0.09	−3.91
Water supply and irrigation	19.9	+1.21	+1.36	−1.73
Food Manufacturing	4.2	+0.79	−0.15	+0.69
Contact centres	3.1	−0.62	−0.10	−0.53
Port and Harbor Operations	3.0	+0.49	+0.23	+0.58
Full-Service Restaurants	5.3	+0.41	+0.18	−0.07
Other Airport Operations	2.7	+0.37	+0.05	+0.17
Hospitals	4.2	+0.24	−0.09	+0.43
Colleges and universities	1.1	+0.18	+0.06	+0.21

*Budget variance covers accounts that carry a budget. Telecoms, executive offices and courts have many small accounts with no budget line.

BY KAM (ACCOUNTS WITH A NAMED KAM)

KAM	Oct 26	vs 2025	vs Sep	vs budget
Simone Chisholm	30.3	+1.08	+2.06	+5.61
Nicole Watson	18.2	+5.53	+1.53	+0.06
Tanya Williams	17.1	+0.99	−0.16	+4.05
Sheryl Davis	10.9	+0.03	+0.15	+1.93
Anna-Kay Toyloy	10.5	−2.10	−0.01	−0.67
Ewan Pitter	9.5	+0.99	+1.25	+2.17
Sharmica Holness	7.3	−6.45	−0.22	−6.64
Ruel Barnett	3.8	−2.05	+0.14	−1.74
Kenroy Williams	3.5	−0.03	+0.07	−1.01
Jean Waugh-Evans	2.8	+0.59	+0.24	+0.98

Sharmica Holness's shortfall against budget is Alcoa, whose main account is 7.1 GWh under.

WHAT THIS TELLS US

- **St James** commercial is −15.7% on last year (−3.8 GWh). This is the hotel belt, and hotels are −4.0 GWh on last October.
- **Clarendon** commercial is −38.3% (−5.8 GWh), which is Alcoa's refinery. Mining is −6.9 GWh on last year.
- **Kingston South** commercial is +14.9% (+6.1 GWh), of which Caribbean Cement is +4.8 on a storm-hit base.
- **Portmore** commercial is +34.6% on September because Caribbean Broilers' main plant is billed there (+1.6 GWh). That is billing timing, not growth. Petrojam does the same for Kingston South (+0.9 GWh).
- **Residential** is up in the east and centre (+5.0% on 2025) and down in the west (−3.5%).

Industry and KAM views cover accounts RT20 and above.

What is driving the swing, and 2027

Residential fell 4.9% on September, all of it in the heavy-use bands, and commercial rose 2.8%, about half of it a rebound from September timing. Neither is a trend, and the 2027 plan leans on both.

RESIDENTIAL: WHERE THE FALL IS (OCTOBER VS SEPTEMBER)

RT10 band (kWh a month)	Oct GWh	vs Sep	Customers	vs Sep	vs 2025
Under 150 kWh	24.1	**+0.49**	322,349	**+6,265**	−3.6%
150 to 350	45.0	**+0.57**	202,160	**+3,392**	0.0%
350 to 550	16.8	**−1.60**	39,241	**−3,537**	+9.0%
550 to 750	7.1	**−1.73**	11,256	**−2,713**	+12.0%
750 to 950	3.7	**−1.09**	4,438	**−1,306**	+14.5%
Over 950	9.8	**−1.91**	5,725	**−1,396**	+14.9%
Prepaid	2.7	**−0.28**	18,090	**+66**	+18.1%

Customers using over 350 kWh a month fell by 8,952 and used 6.3 GWh less, while the two lowest bands added 1.1 GWh. The fall is in the heavy users, which points to cooling load easing as the weather cools. Temperature data would confirm it.

COMMERCIAL: WHAT MOVED (SEPTEMBER TO OCTOBER, GWH, BY CUSTOMER)

Customer	Sep	Oct	Change	Read
National Water Commission	16.70	18.41	**+1.71**	water supply
Caribbean Broilers Ja Ltd	0.82	2.45	**+1.63**	billing timing
Petrojam Ltd	1.09	2.02	**+0.93**	billing timing
Ministry of Education	2.00	2.44	**+0.44**	—
Windalco	1.90	2.22	**+0.33**	—
PriceSmart (Jamaica) Ltd	0.61	0.88	**+0.27**	—
Alcoa Mins Of Ja Ltd	0.82	0.39	**−0.44**	Alcoa exit
National Irrigation Commission	1.64	1.27	**−0.37**	water supply
CNX Services Jamaica ltd	0.32	0.16	**−0.16**	—
West Meat Packers Ja Ltd	0.35	0.21	**−0.14**	—

Net movement across customers is +5.2 GWh. Timing at Caribbean Broilers and Petrojam accounts for +2.6 GWh of it, 49%.

WHAT IS DRIVING THE SWING

- **Residential vs September (−5.6 GWh).** This is seasonal and sits in the heavy-use bands. It is also deeper than the −1.8% October move in 2024. The structural drags are small but real: we have 857 net-export accounts against 501 last October, exporting 331 MWh against 94, and 7,742 more premises sitting at zero consumption.
- **Residential vs the LE.** The LE has RT10 flat on September, while 2024 and 2025 both show a fall. That is phasing, not weakness, but it carries into November and December.
- **Commercial vs September (+5.1 GWh).** Half is a rebound from a low September at Caribbean Broilers and Petrojam, so October is a normal month and not a step up. National Water Commission's +1.7 GWh is the one rise that is not timing: 18.4 GWh against 17.3 and 17.2 in July and August, with water supply +6.4% on last year. Whether it holds depends on pumping demand.

FY2026 LANDING IF THE YEAR ENDS LIKE 2024 (GWH)

Class	FY26 LE	FY26 outlook	Gap	FY27 plan	vs LE	vs outlook
RT10	1,222.8	1,192.9	**−29.9**	1,275.0	+4.3%	**+6.9%**
RT20	654.7	652.2	**−2.5**	691.6	+5.6%	**+6.0%**
RT40	771.9	784.8	**+12.8**	838.6	+8.6%	**+6.9%**
RT50	345.7	350.8	**+5.1**	400.8	+16.0%	**+14.3%**
RT60	37.5	37.9	**+0.5**	39.8	+6.2%	**+4.9%**
RT70	267.2	272.1	**+4.9**	193.7	−27.5%	**−28.8%**
System	**3,299.7**	**3,290.7**	**−9.0**	**3,439.5**	**+4.2%**	**+4.5%**

The outlook is January to October actual, with November and December run from October's level and 2024's October to December pattern for each class (RT70 held flat). It rests on one year's pattern, so treat it as an indication, not a forecast.

Is it sustainable through 2027? Our view is that the commercial position holds and the residential plan does not, as it stands. On this outlook FY2026 lands 9 GWh (0.3%) below the LE in total, but with a different mix: residential and RT20 −32 GWh and large commercial +23 GWh. **Residential:** the November and December fall is seasonal and the LE does not carry it, so FY2027 needs RT10 growth of +6.9% on where we expect to finish, against the planned +4.3%. That leans on the 7,742 zero-consumption premises coming back (worth roughly 1.3% of RT10 at the average 181 kWh a month) and on normal weather. **Commercial:** October is a clean base, so large commercial needs +1.9% against the +3.6% in the plan, provided the hotels reopen on schedule (1,982 rooms in December and 2,524 in the first half of 2027) and we lose no further customers to self-generation. Each 1% on residential is 12.8 GWh in 2027.

The LE is the financials forecast held at 3,299.7 GWh for FY2026. FY2027 is the approved plan.